

Governance Plan: In-Home Dog Boarding Process Package

Version: 1.0 **Published:** 2026-04-12 **DRI:** Abbey Cohen, Dog Sitter / Process Owner **Next Review Date:** 2026-07-12 (or sooner if something significant changes, like a new platform, new policies, or expanded services) **Applies to:** All artifacts in the In-Home Dog Boarding Process Package (SOP, BPMN diagram, discovery notes)

1. Purpose

This document lays out a simple governance plan for the In-Home Dog Boarding Process Package. The goal is to make sure the documentation stays accurate and useful over time: who's responsible for it, when it gets reviewed, how changes get made, and what happens when something goes wrong or doesn't fit the current process.

2. Directly Responsible Individual (DRI)

Field	Value
Name	Abbey Cohen
Role	Dog Sitter / Process Owner
Responsibilities	Keep the SOP accurate; review it on schedule and whenever something big changes; approve any updates; maintain version history

Abbey is the sole owner of this process package. Since this is a one-person operation, she's both the process owner and the person responsible for keeping the documentation current. All decisions about what to change, when to review, and what the process should say are hers.

A note on how this was built: I (Jason Geanuracos) drafted the SOP (v1.0-v1.1), the BPMN diagram, and this governance plan based on the process outline Abbey shared with me. From here, Abbey takes it over.

3. RACI

Activity	DRI (Abbey Cohen)	Documentation Consultant (Jason Geanuracos)
Maintain and update SOP	R/A	n/a
Review on scheduled cadence	R/A	n/a
Approve changes (any type)	A	n/a
Identify process gaps or inaccuracies	R/A	C (initial version only)
Update BPMN diagram	R/A	C (initial version only)
Communicate process changes to clients	R/A	n/a

Key: R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, n/a = Not involved

4. Review Cadence

Routine Reviews

The plan is to review the process package once per quarter:

Review Window	Target Date
Q2 2026 review	July 2026
Q3 2026 review	October 2026
Q4 2026 review	January 2027
Q1 2027 review	April 2027

A quarterly cadence makes sense for a newer process. It gives Abbey a regular checkpoint to catch anything that isn't working before it becomes a bigger issue, without being so frequent that it's a burden.

Trigger-Based Reviews

Some changes shouldn't wait for the annual review. A review should happen right away if:

- A new booking platform is adopted (e.g., switching from direct text to Rover or Wag)
- Care policies change (e.g., new rules on number of dogs, breed restrictions, or emergency vet authorization)
- An incident during a stay reveals a gap the current SOP didn't cover
- Client feedback keeps pointing to the same confusion or missing step
- The service expands into something new (dog walking, daycare, other animals, etc.)

If the triggering change affects how active bookings are handled, it's worth pausing new bookings until the SOP is updated.

5. Change Control

When something in the process package needs to change, here's the basic workflow:

1. **Identify:** Notice something that needs updating, whether from a scheduled review, an incident, or client feedback
2. **Evaluate:** Figure out the scope. Does it affect just the SOP, just the diagram, or both?
3. **Update:** Make the edits and increment the SOP version:
 - **Patch** (x.x.1): Typo fix, formatting cleanup, minor clarification with no real procedural change
 - **Minor** (x.1.0): Updated step, new decision rule, or clarified scope
 - **Major** (x.0.0): Big change to the overall process, roles, or structure
4. **Record:** Add a short note to the SOP governance header: version, date, what changed
5. **Regenerate:** If the BPMN diagram changed, export a new PDF before replacing the old one

6. Escalation

This is a one-person operation, so escalation is pretty straightforward.

Situation	What to do
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A step in the SOP is unclear or missing a decision rule	Update the SOP, increment the version, note the change in the governance header
An incident during a stay reveals a gap	Handle the follow-up with the client first, then update the SOP before the next booking
A client disputes a care decision covered by the SOP	Resolve it directly with the client; update the SOP if the dispute points to real ambiguity
A process change affects what clients expect (e.g., new meet and greet policy)	Let active clients know before the change takes effect; update the SOP to match

7. Sunset and Refresh

Milestone	Date
Package first drafted	2026-04-07
Governance layer added	2026-04-12
Next scheduled review	2026-07-12
Sunset evaluation	2027-04-12: Abbey decides whether to renew, archive, or retire

If the dog boarding service shuts down, the package gets archived and marked inactive. If something major changes (new platform, new care model, expanded services), that triggers an out-of-cycle review and resets the annual review clock from that date.

This governance plan covers all artifacts in the In-Home Dog Boarding Process Package. For the full version history, see the governance header in `capstone/SOP.md`.